

◆ Activity: "Mission Critical – Navigating Change in Real Time"

Objective:

This high-stakes business simulation challenges participants to navigate a sudden, disruptive change in a fast-growing tech company. Teams will need to assess the situation, identify agility barriers, manage resistance, and propose an execution plan under pressure—while another group observes and analyzes their reactions to change.

◆ Step 1: The Thought-Provoking Case Study (10 mins)

Background: The Rise of NovaTech

NovaTech, a leading AI-driven SaaS company, has been dominating the market with its predictive analytics platform used by Fortune 500 companies. Founded in 2015, the company has grown from 20 employees to 2,500 and currently holds a market share of 32% in AI-based data analytics solutions.

The company's flagship product, NovaAI, provides real-time business intelligence using machine learning. Over the past two years, NovaAI has driven \$250 million in revenue and boasts global clients across finance, retail, and healthcare.

Recently, NovaTech announced Project VisionX, a revolutionary AI model set to launch in 6 months, aimed at disrupting the industry with self-learning algorithms that predict customer trends with 94% accuracy—a significant leap ahead of competitors.

The Disruption: A Major Competitor Strikes First

During a routine investor meeting, NovaTech's executive team gets shocking news: NeuralLogic, their top competitor, just launched "Clairvoyant AI"—a near-identical product to VisionX.

Not only has NeuralLogic launched first, but:

- Clairvoyant AI claims 97% prediction accuracy, surpassing NovaTech.
- The company announced a \$500 million investment in AI infrastructure.
- Major clients (including two of NovaTech's biggest accounts) are considering switching.
- Industry analysts predict NovaTech could lose up to 20% market share in the next quarter.

✳ NovaTech's leadership must act NOW. The 6-month roadmap for VisionX is no longer viable. The company has only 12 weeks to launch a competitive product—or risk irrelevance.

The Key Characters

1. **Ethan Reid (CEO & Founder, 40 years old)** – Visionary leader, built NovaTech from the ground up. Struggles with letting go of traditional company structures and making rapid pivots.
2. **Sophia Chan (Chief Technology Officer, 38 years old)** – AI specialist, deeply involved in VisionX's development. Sees rushing the launch as a risk to product quality.
3. **Raj Patel (VP of Product, 42 years old)** – Balances business needs with technology, but faces resistance from his team, who believe VisionX is not ready.
4. **Jim Carter (Director of Engineering, 35 years old)** – Highly agile thinker, wants to scrap the current roadmap and pivot to an MVP approach.
5. **Maya Ali (Head of Client Relations, 45 years old)** – Concerned about retaining key clients and believes focusing on marketing and client engagement is more urgent than development.

◆ Step 2: The Execution Phase (15 mins)

🔔 Team Task: Respond to the Crisis

🔗 Group 1 – The Execution Team

- Your job is to **craft an agility plan** for NovaTech to successfully respond to this crisis.
- You must decide:
 - Which change management strategies will help accelerate VisionX's launch?
 - Should you pivot the product roadmap? If yes, how?
 - How do you manage internal resistance from employees hesitant to change direction?
 - How will you communicate this change to employees and clients?
 - What are the biggest risks of this change, and how do you mitigate them?

❖ **Group 2 – The Observation Team**

- Your job is to analyze how the Execution Team reacts to change.
- Observe who resists, who adapts, and how effectively they collaborate under pressure.
- Take notes on:
 - Who demonstrates leadership agility?
 - Who struggles with change and why?
 - What behavioral patterns emerge (frustration, confusion, teamwork, initiative, hesitation)?
 - Who applies learning agility principles like mental agility, people agility, and results agility?